

IE

INSIDER TIPS



ABOUT IE

IE was founded in 1973 as a Business School for Executives and has grown into IE University, with five different schools offering degrees at the undergraduate and master's levels. IE was founded by a young entrepreneur with a vision to create a unique learning experience, focused on innovation and humanities, two core elements of the school values and culture that continue to thrive. Students join an extremely diverse student body and are challenged in entrepreneurial thinking and sustainability to reimagine business and to create a better world.

IE continues to innovate as the world changes, developing a Liquid Learning model to adapt to the current needs of the students and the world we live in, leveraging technology to foster a fluid approach to learning from anywhere.

IE's flagship International MBA is an accelerated 11-month program open only to those who have three or more years of work experience. Students can join in September or January, and the program is offered in two language tracks: English only or English and Spanish.

IE Business School is located in the heart of Madrid, Spain, and has a network of 30 international offices, which support Admissions, Careers and Alumni Relations.

STRENGTHS & SPECIALIZATIONS

(Social) Entrepreneurship, International Management and
Information Technology

KEY STATS

MBA RANKINGS*	2012	2013	2014	2015	2016	2017	2018	2019
Business Week	3	-	1	-	-	8	12	9
Financial Times	3	4	5	-	-	4	-	9
Forbes	-	5	-	-	-	3	-	6
The Economist	7	15	9	-	-	8	16	19
US News	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-

CLASS OF 2020 ADMISSIONS

Avg Age	29
% International	92%
% Women	31%
Total Tuition	US\$72,200

POST-MBA CAREERS (CLASS OF 2019)

Financial Services	20%
Technology	20%
Consulting	17%
Consumer Goods	9%

TOP RECRUITERS INCLUDE:

Amazon, Uber, Microsoft, Salesforce, BCG, McKinsey, Kearney, Credit Suisse, UBS, BNP Paribas, Mastercard, Barclays, Santander, Diageo, AB InBev

AVERAGE BASE SALARY: €95,350

EMPLOYED IN 3 MONTHS: 95%

*Rankings are relative to other U.S. business schools. [Read more](#) about the Fortuna ranking methodology.



TOP TIPS FOR ACING YOUR IE APPLICATION

BY LISA BEVILL

As Admissions Director for IE Business School's entire full-time program portfolio, including the flagship International MBA program, Lisa was responsible for shaping a diverse and highly qualified student population. She now dedicates her time to Leadership Development through coaching, teaching, and training.



What's critical for IE is to showcase your unique self, how your values align naturally with the school, and how you will contribute to the school's dynamic and diverse environment.

1

SHOWCASE THE AUTHENTIC YOU

The International MBA is an MBA out of the ordinary. IE aims to craft a class of authentic leaders who see the world differently. Armed with an open and growth mindset, the students who make up the MBA classes at IE thrive at challenging the status quo and are motivated to create a better world. What makes you unique? How can you celebrate you and share the real story?

IE convenes amazing individuals to learn together and grow, so share how your contributions stand to enhance the experience. It is important to be yourself and to be authentic, letting your personality shine through.

DEMONSTRATE YOUR ENTREPRENEURIAL MINDSET

2

Innovative thinking and an entrepreneurial mindset are at the core of IE and form an integral part of the International MBA.

Weaving your curiosity and perspective into new ways of approaching challenges will be fundamental to your application and your experience at IE. Have you started your own company?

When have you recognized an opportunity to create and innovate where others have seen challenges?

Showcase your ability to think critically and design new ways of working, considering the 4th industrial revolution and technology as a drive to change.

3

YOUR ABILITY TO ADAPT TO CHANGE

IE is about embracing change and adapting to challenges. With innovation at its core, change is a part of the IE culture. How do you adapt to change? How are you learning and developing skills to continuously grow, both personally and professional?

Some people are comfortable with change and such individuals thrive at IE. Often those people undervalue their capacity to adapt, so being able to articulate this important skill in your application is key.

HOW YOU VALUE DIVERSITY

4

Diversity is only the first step, inclusion and leveraging diversity is where the real magic happens. What is your experience in diverse teams? How have you been able to drive greater outcomes due to bringing in diverse perspectives and skill sets?

Demonstrating your self awareness, open-mindedness to difference, and awareness of the value of building inclusive teams will distinguish your application.

5

BE A HOLISTIC LEADER

Each individual is considered holistically as to the experience, perspective, and attitude they bring into the program to contribute to an inclusive and innovative learning environment. IE has created the first transversal Center for Health, Well-being and Happiness in a European Business School and considers your mental, emotional, and physical well-being as critical to your ability to lead yourself and others. Highlight your appreciation of a holistic leader and the practices you have developed to continuously learn and grow with positive impact.

ESSAY ANALYSIS



ESSAY Question: What is the most important thing that you would like us to know that is not in your resume or application?

The single and broad essay question is a challenge and opportunity at the same time, indicating the importance of diversity and innovation in your application. You have the space to share your passion and alignment with the school values and culture, while demonstrating your unique perspective, experience, value, and your vision of the future. Leverage the essay to shine as your unique self. Take advantage to consider what is most important to you and how you are focused on moving forward on the path to your vision.

Having a blank canvas can be daunting, so take some time to consider what is important to you and the most relevant examples to showcase who you are. Leverage this opportunity to share what motivates you and how you are on your own development journey to continue learning and impacting. Share your vision and dive into the specifics with examples which highlight your learning.

As the question is broad, it is important to be specific to what is relevant to you and to be concise in communicating your story.

Video Essay Questions: During this exercise you will be answering questions to demonstrate why you would be a valuable asset to the IEU community. This will take around 20-30 minutes.

The video essays are a great way to stand out in who you are and what makes you unique. These are dynamic opportunities in real-time to be you and tell your story.

There is a bank of questions selected at random, so be prepared in advance for anything and jump into the question asked. You may be asked to give your opinion on topics such as the future of work, entrepreneurship in underdeveloped countries, or themes related to diversity and inclusion. The focus is on your value and how you express it. Think about examples and stories that can support your ideas and bring them to life.

Take time to prepare yourself mentally, emotionally, and physically to showcase the amazing person you are and your fit with the IE culture.

DEADLINES & DATES

IE operates a rolling admissions process for both its September and January intakes and you can apply at any time. Competition does increase as the start date of the program approaches, so we encourage applicants to consider applying earlier in the cycle if possible.



**The best time to
apply is when you're
ready.**

Caroline Diarte Edwards,
Co-Founder & Director of Fortuna Admissions

LET'S GET YOU IN.

Fortuna Admissions is a dream team of former MBA Admissions Directors and Officers from the top-tier business schools, including Wharton, INSEAD, Harvard Business School, Stanford GSB, Kellogg, LBS, Chicago Booth, MIT Sloan, Columbia, NYU Stern, IE, Duke Fuqua, UCLA Anderson, Yale SOM, Cornell Johnson and Berkeley Haas.

As industry experts, we regularly provide commentary and analysis about b-school admissions for major media around the world. To read our full range of advice visit: FortunaAdmissions.com

With our unparalleled collective expertise, we are able to coach you to develop a clear vision of your goals for business school and beyond. We work closely with you throughout the application process and provide expert guidance at every stage to maximize your chances of admission to a top school.

Our free consultations are consistently rated as the best in the industry. To learn more about Fortuna and assess your chances of admission, reserve yours at: FortunaAdmissions.com

